Hackathon Fulda

Challenge Description for Hackathon Fulda 2026

“Future Education – Rethinking Learning, Teaching and Assessment”

Artificial intelligence and other digital technologies are changing the way we learn, share knowledge and develop skills. Information is available at any time, AI systems can answer complex questions, generate content and help solve a wide range of tasks. This creates new opportunities for schools, universities and businesses – but also new challenges for learning processes, assessments and preparation for professional life.

Under the theme “Future Education”, Hackathon Fulda 2026 invites you to develop innovative solutions for the future of education. We are looking for digital applications, technical prototypes and new concepts that make learning more personalised, effective and accessible, support teachers and training professionals, or fundamentally rethink existing educational processes.

This year, we place particular emphasis on creativity, the quality of the underlying concept and the clear practical benefits of the developed solution for teachers or learners. At the same time, we expect technically robust and demonstrable results whose functionality and added value can be clearly illustrated through a prototype or demonstrator.

Powerful AI tools are also transforming software development, making it possible to generate extensive amounts of code in a short time. We have therefore adjusted our evaluation criteria: The sheer volume or technical complexity of the code will carry less weight in the overall assessment. Instead, greater emphasis will be placed on problem-solving, originality, user-centred design, conceptual quality and convincing implementation.

Your goal: Develop solutions that help people learn successfully, apply knowledge and build the right skills for the future in a world increasingly shaped by AI.

Possible Challenges

The following challenges can serve as starting points for your solutions:

Challenge: Assessments in the Age of AI

AI can generate texts, solve assignments and summarise complex content, making traditional assessment formats increasingly less meaningful as measures of individual achievement.

Develop a solution that makes assessments in schools or higher education fair, meaningful and as resistant to cheating as possible in the age of AI – or fundamentally rethinks how assessments should work.

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Challenge: Smart Management of Vocational Training and University Studies

Vocational training programmes and university studies involve numerous learning modules, practical placements, supervisors and individual learning progress, making it difficult for everyone involved to maintain a clear overview.

Develop a digital solution that intelligently connects this information, makes educational pathways transparent and provides targeted support for learners.

Challenge: Social Learning Instead of Social Scrolling

Young people spend considerable amounts of time on TikTok, Instagram, YouTube and other platforms. However, consuming content on these platforms does not automatically promote lasting learning, critical thinking or media literacy.

Develop a solution that uses digital habits and social media mechanisms to create effective and motivating learning experiences.

Challenge: AI Coach for the Job Application Process

Many young people need guidance and individual support when preparing application documents, attending job interviews, keeping track of deadlines and planning their entry into professional life.

Develop a responsible AI-powered assistant that guides them through the application process while strengthening their independence and ability to make their own decisions.

Challenge: Finding Your Way in a Changing World of Work

Job profiles and the skills required for future careers are changing, while the sheer number of university degree programmes and vocational training opportunities makes it increasingly difficult for young people to find their way.

Develop a solution that provides guidance, takes individual interests and abilities into account, and clearly presents suitable educational and career pathways.

Challenge: AI as a Critical Learning Companion in Higher Education

AI can help students understand academic texts, but it can also generate incorrect or seemingly plausible content and often reinforces existing assumptions rather than challenging them.

Develop a solution that encourages students to think critically – for example, an AI tutor that deliberately challenges their arguments, asks probing questions and identifies gaps in their reasoning.

The challenges listed above are intended to provide inspiration and possible starting points for your work.

You are equally welcome to draw on your own experiences, real-world problems, ideas or suggestions for improvement from schools, universities, vocational training or professional life, and use them to develop your own solution within the scope of “Future Education”.